- **Being a store of value**: Money should maintain its value over time, making it useful as a way to save and invest the value of human labor. This allows people to use money as a tool to plan for the future and to borrow and lend money to each other.

What's your store of value?

	BTC (USD)	Gold (USD)	USD (EUR)	ETH (USD)
March 14, 2019	$3,846	$1,293	€0.8817	$136.86
March 14, 2020	$5,258	$1,529	€0.90056	$127.76
Gain/Loss	+36.71%	+18.25%	+2.14%	-6.65%

So next time you're saving up for something special, remember that money is more than just a way to pay for things - it's a tool to help you plan and invest in your future.

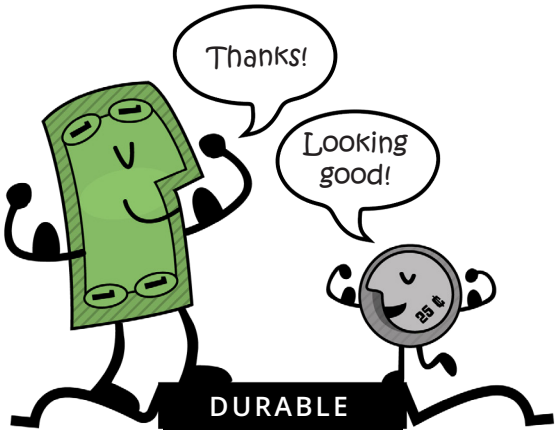
These three functions are what allow economies to become complex and dynamic. Without money, it would be much harder to buy and sell goods and services, and our economy would be much less developed.

Class Exercise. What function of money is this an example of?

1. Roby decided to save a portion of his weekly paychecks to buy a puppy. _____
2. Jim buys two slices of pizza for $8.30 at Ray's Pizza. _____
3. Marc can't decide whether to buy concert tickets for $75 or buy a ski pass for $95. _____

1.3.3 Money Characteristics

Over time, people ultimately have realized that money must possess certain qualities in order to be effective as a medium of exchange. These characteristics include durability, portability, divisibility, fungibility, scarcity, and acceptability.

- ***Durability*** refers to the ability of money to resist physical deterioration and last over time. This ensures that money can circulate in the economy in an acceptable and recognizable state.

Gold is a durable material that can withstand wear and tear, making it a good representation of the durability characteristic of money.